

CHAPTER 12

Apparel Merchandising

RNRPZT

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- **To know the meaning of apparel merchandising**
- **To understand the merchandising process**
- **To learn the methods used in apparel merchandising**

12.1 INTRODUCTION

Merchandising is an important part of marketing. It is the planning and supervision involved in marketing a particular product and making it available at places, times, prices and in quantities that will best serve to realize the marketing objectives of a business. It involves all activities necessary to determine and satisfy the wants and needs of a consumer. It offers the goods at time and in a place where it can be conveniently purchased. The products must be available in good quantities and in qualities. In textile industry many methods of production are employed to produce products. The techniques adopted to sell the products to consumers are referred as apparel merchandising.

Merchandising deals with the selection, orders and purchase of actual product. One must understand that demand is the foundation upon which all retailers plan their merchandise. Merchandise is chosen carefully to best serve the needs of the target market. The merchandiser requires special skills which include, predicting what one will sell and when it well sell best. A thorough knowledge of the merchandise that includes garment types, its details and methods of production, qualities and finishes are prerequisites to merchandising.

Apparel merchandising involves a constant watch of the production of the apparel products. Merchandiser should be well aware of what a customer wants this season and whether the product produced by the manufacturer is as per the needs of the customer. He should inform the customer about the styles, quantity and quality of the product required and the time when the goods will reach the customer. Merchandising is the job where the merchandiser should have a constant interface with production and see that the ultimate aim of satisfying customer needs.

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